

Study Report: Beginning Power BI - Power BI Analyst

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Family: Power BI Analyst
Level: Beginner
Chapters: 7
Source: Reference: Beginning Power BI - Mark Pagani

Official sources and free libraries

- <https://www.apress.com/gp/book/9781484298794>

Summary

Study report for **Beginning Power BI** by Mark Pagani (Beginner level) mapped to the Power BI Analyst role. Power BI Desktop basics: import, model, visualize, publish.

Chapters

Track: Book-Intro

Chapter 1: About Beginning Power BI [Beginner]

Chapter focus: About Beginning Power BI** ***(Level: Beginner)**

This study report summarizes **Beginning Power BI** by Mark Pagani for the Power BI Analyst role. The resource is rated Beginner level. Power BI Desktop basics: import, model, visualize, publish. Use this report alongside the official material to prepare for CodeQuest review.

Code Reference:

```
# Beginning Power BI
# Author: Mark Pagani
# Role: Power BI Analyst
# Level: Beginner
```

What it shows: Metadata block records the source book and target role family.

Topic guide

What it actually is

A structured study report based on Beginning Power BI.

When to use it

When learning Power BI Analyst skills at Beginner level.

Where to use it

Power BI Analyst training paths and certification prep.

Real use example

A learner reads this report before starting the full book or free online guide.

Track: Book-Context

Chapter 2: Why This Book Matters for Your Role [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Why This Book Matters for Your Role *(Level: Beginner)**

Power BI Analyst professionals use ideas from Beginning Power BI to solve real workplace problems. Power BI Desktop basics: import, model, visualize, publish. This chapter explains how the book fits into your learning path and what you should be able to do after studying it.

Code Reference:

Role: Power BI Analyst

Book focus: Power BI Desktop basics: import, model, visualize, publish.

Recommended level: Beginner

What it shows: Connects the book topic to the job role outcomes.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Role-aligned learning connects theory to job tasks.

When to use it

During career planning and syllabus design.

Where to use it

Power BI Analyst bootcamps and CodeQuest teacher assignments.

Real use example

A teacher assigns this book report before a beginner skills checkpoint.

Track: Book-Topics

Chapter 3: Key Topics Covered [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Key Topics Covered *(Level: Beginner)**

The main topics in Beginning Power BI include practical concepts described as: Power BI Desktop basics: import, model, visualize, publish. Study each topic with hands-on practice. Take notes on definitions, workflows, and examples that match tools used in Power BI Analyst jobs today.

Code Reference:

- Topic 1: core concept
- Topic 2: core concept
- Topic 3: core concept
- Topic 4: core concept

What it shows: Topic list guides what to study chapter-by-chapter in the source.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Topic maps turn a book into actionable learning objectives.

When to use it

Before reading and while building chapter summaries.

Where to use it

Self-study, flipped classroom, and revision.

Real use example

A student maps each book chapter to a CodeQuest report section.

Track: Book-Applied

Chapter 4: Applied: Power BI Analyst Role Overview [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Power BI Analyst Role Overview *(Level: Beginner)**

Power BI analysts bridge data engineering and business users. You model data, write DAX, design reports, and publish to the Power BI Service. With Microsoft Fabric (2024+), the role extends into lakehouse ingestion - still centered on trusted semantic models.

Code Reference:

- Power BI connects to hundreds of sources
- Typical flow: Get Data -> Transform -> Model -> Report -> Publish

What it shows: The analyst workflow is linear but iterative - model changes ripple to all reports.

Topic guide

What it actually is

A Power BI analyst builds self-serve analytics on Microsoft's BI stack.

When to use it

Organizations standardized on Microsoft 365, Azure, and Fabric.

Where to use it

Finance reporting, sales ops, HR analytics, and operational KPIs.

Real use example

A regional manager filters a published report by territory without emailing IT for a CSV.

Chapter 5: Applied: Connecting to Data Sources [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Connecting to Data Sources *(Level: Beginner)**

Power BI connects to Excel, SQL Server, Snowflake, SharePoint, and Fabric OneLake. Choose Import for speed, DirectQuery for real-time, or Direct Lake (Fabric) for large Delta tables. Document gateway requirements for on-prem sources.

Code Reference:

```
let
    Source = Sql.Database("server", "dw"),
    Sales = Source{[Schema="dbo", Item="fact_sales"]}[Data]
in
    Sales
```

What it shows: Power Query M loads SQL table fact_sales - first step in most enterprise models.

Topic guide**What it actually is**

Get Data establishes the pipeline from source systems into Power BI.

When to use it

Every new dashboard starts with source connections.

Where to use it

SQL warehouses, Excel finance files, and OData APIs.

Real use example

Analyst connects Snowflake marketing spend to internal CRM for unified campaign ROI.

Chapter 6: Applied: Power Query Transformations [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Power Query Transformations *(Level: Beginner)**

Power Query is click-first ETL: remove columns, filter rows, split columns, unpivot. Applied Steps are reproducible - rename steps clearly. Prefer Table.Buffer for small lookups, not million-row tables.

Code Reference:

```
let
```

```
Source = Csv.Document(File.Contents("orders.csv")),
Promoted = Table.PromoteHeaders(Source),
Typed = Table.TransformColumnTypes(Promoted, {{"amount", type number}})
in
Typed
```

What it shows: PromoteHeaders + type coercion prevents DAX treating amounts as text.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Power Query cleans and shapes data before modeling.

When to use it

When source exports need cleansing every refresh.

Where to use it

Weekly CSV drops, API JSON flattening, and Excel consolidation.

Real use example

Unpivoting wide month columns turns twelve columns into a tidy date/value pair for charting.

Track: Book-Plan

Chapter 7: Study Plan and Practice [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Study Plan and Practice** *(Level: Beginner)

Finish Beginning Power BI with a weekly plan: read one section, write a summary, complete one exercise, and reflect on how it applies to Power BI Analyst. If a free edition exists, practice every example. Submit your notes and one mini-project demo for teacher review.

Code Reference:

```
Week 1: Read + notes
Week 2: Exercises
Week 3: Mini project
Week 4: Review + quiz
```

What it shows: A 4-week plan turns reading into demonstrable skill.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Structured study plans improve retention and portfolio outcomes.

When to use it

After finishing the key topics chapters.

Where to use it

CodeQuest end-of-unit assessments.

Real use example

A learner completes the study plan and uploads a beginner project screenshot.